

Data cleaning before migration

A practical process for moving CRM data without moving the mess.

Work through the four stages before anything is imported into the new CRM.

- 1 Decide what should move: separate active, useful records from archive material
- 2 Standardise the structure: naming, formats, required fields, and valid values
- 3 Resolve duplicates and gaps: matching rules, source of truth, human review queue
- 4 Test and reconcile: import a sample, inspect relationships, compare totals
- 5 Every record has a clear answer on operational, customer, or reporting value
- 6 Every record has a named owner represented correctly in the new system
- 7 Trusted fields are mapped and unreliable fields are consciously left behind
- 8 Contacts, companies, deals, tickets, and activities stay connected
- 9 A written rule decides whether two records are the same person or company
- 10 Someone signs off the sample import and the final reconciliation

More history is not more value. Move what the team will actually use.